School Closure Report

Creston Elementary School

Date: 11/17/2026

School Closure Process
The PPS Board of Education determines whether schools will be closed. Board determination on school closures is based on the Superintendent's recommendation. The School Initiation & Closure policy (6.10.030-P) requires that the Superintendent's recommendation be accompanied by a School Closure Report.

If you have questions about this process or this report, please contact:

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501 N Dixon, Portland, OR 97227 | 503-916-2000

1. School Profile

School Name
Creston Elementary School

Administrator
Karl Logan

Location
4701 SE Bush St, Portland OR

Grade levels served
K-5

1a. School Description

Creston is a neighborhood K–5 school serving the Creston-Kenilworth neighborhood of Southeast Portland, adjacent to Creston Park and Pool. The school partners with Columbia Regional Inclusive Services to provide programming for students who are deaf and hard of hearing and shares space with PPS's Head Start program in the Creston Annex. Approximately 240 students are enrolled at Creston for the 2026-27 school year.

1b. Financial Impact

The primary financial benefit of consolidating elementary schools and programs is to align school capacity and operating costs with enrollment, allowing PPS to concentrate limited resources in fewer, more efficiently resourced schools. Combining school communities can reduce duplicative school-level administrative and operating expenses, improve building utilization, and support more efficient staffing and program delivery. These consolidations are intended to generate ongoing savings while supporting strong core instructional programs and student services.

If the school remains open, the projected cost per student for the 2027/2028 school year is: $31,194.

If the school is closed in 2027, the projected overall savings is $1,085,010. This includes savings from administrative, custodial, and office staffing, 80% of utilities and includes the one-time cost of teacher moves. We anticipate ongoing expenses, including 20% of current utility costs and an average annual security cost, if the school were closed and unoccupied.

Under the proposed change, 41% of students would live more than one mile from Atkinson and would be offered school bus transportation. To accommodate these students, PPS anticipates increasing service to Atkinson from two to four buses. The Transportation Department estimates an additional annual cost of approximately $17,000.

Transportation and Safe Routes to School planning will identify needed supports for safe arrival and dismissal, including walking and biking improvements, crossing supports, or traffic circulation changes.

1c. Student Enrollment

Table 1. Projected enrollment over the next five years, if school remains open:

School Year	2027-28	2028-29	2029-30	2030-31	2031-32
Students Enrolled	201	191	189	188	187

History of Requested and Actual Transfers
During 2024-2025, 2025-2026, and 2026-2027 school years, 43 students requested transfers into Creston and 19 enrolled through an approved transfer. During the same period, 131 students residing within the school's attendance area requested transfers to other schools, and 49 enrolled elsewhere through an approved transfer.

Projected declining enrollment will make it difficult to maintain stable staffing, full programming, and essential student support services. Under enrollment-based staffing allocations, low enrollment can result in year-to-year staffing changes, blended-grade classrooms or combined programs, and reduced access to enrichment and student support offerings. Staff may serve multiple roles or split time across schools, limiting continuity and availability. While educators would continue working to meet students' needs, projected enrollment would constrain the school's ability to provide consistent access to a well-rounded educational experience without ongoing supplemental district resources.

2. School Facilities and Student Reassignment

2a. School Description

Built 1948 (Primary)	**Building size** 79,978 SF	**Stories** 1	**Acres** 8.64
Building condition Poor; FCI 0.16	**Gross capacity** 609 Students	**Functional capacity** 558 Students	**Cost of school operations** $5,958,144

Gross capacity is the estimated maximum number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by assigning a student capacity to each classroom based on its square footage and summing those capacities:

- Less than 800 square feet: 24 students
- 800–1,000 square feet: 27 students
- More than 1,000 square feet: 30 students

Functional capacity is a practical estimate of the number of students a school can accommodate, calculated by multiplying its gross capacity by the applicable utilization rate. It does not represent maximum occupancy under building code requirements or determine

staffing levels.

The cost of school operations includes projected FY28 school-based costs in funds 100 and 200 plus Facilities, Nutrition Services, and Special Education, at the current service level.

Physical Condition of Building, Capital and Environmental Needs
Creston is a single-story International style school with a separate Creston Annex. The HVAC equipment and much of the electrical system are beyond their typical design lives. Creston has no fire-suppression system, weathered exterior wood trim, deteriorating mortar and separation in brick walls, cracking in exterior concrete finishes, and aging interior finishes.

ADA Accessibility
Creston is a single story building with an accessible main entrance.

Building Use
Currently, the campus houses a K–5 neighborhood school, regional Deaf and Hard of Hearing programming through Columbia Regional Inclusive Services, and preschool in the Creston Annex, which would remain open as a preschool center.

Analysis of current and potential use of the facility, including recommended disposition
Following closure, potential uses of the Creston Elementary School facility will be evaluated through the district's Building Repurposing process, informed by community engagement, district needs, facility conditions, and financial considerations. This process will consider opportunities to support students and the surrounding community and identify a recommended future use or disposition for Board consideration.

2b. Student Reassignment

The proposed closure of Creston as a K–5 school would reassign neighborhood students, including Special Education Learning Center students, to Atkinson and relocate the regional Deaf and Hard of Hearing program to Glencoe. The neighborhood pathway would continue through Kellogg Middle School and Franklin High School, while Glencoe would connect the DHH program to its Mt. Tabor Middle School pathway. The Creston Annex would remain open as a preschool center.

Proposed Attendance Boundary
See attached map.

Transportation options and barriers
Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, and school bus service for elementary students who live more than one mile from their neighborhood school; additional students may qualify based on Oregon Department of Education guidelines or individual needs. We do not anticipate any barriers to students getting to school; however, additional bussing may be provided, as needed, for hazard areas within the school attendance boundary.

How will this school location accommodate the reassigned students?
Atkinson has 25 regular classrooms and a functional capacity of 519 students. After consolidation with Creston, Atkinson is projected to hold 474 students for the 2027-2028 school year.

Recommendation
PPS recommends closing Creston as a K–5 school for the 2027–2028 school year, assigning neighborhood K–5 students to Atkinson, and relocating the Deaf and Hard of Hearing program to Glencoe. The Creston Annex would remain open as a preschool center. Neighborhood students would follow the Kellogg and Franklin pathway, while the regional DHH program would maintain its Mt. Tabor connection.

3. Community/Cluster and District Impact Analysis

3a. Cluster Analysis

How will the proposed closure maintain or improve equity of access to schools offering high quality educational choices?

In the 2026-2027 school year, PPS staffs and supports 56 elementary programs. Eleven of these programs are situated within K-8 campuses. The enrollment of these programs ranges from 160 students to over 550 students. Using the QEM and our system definition of "well-resourced schools" as a guide, we have established an elementary enrollment of 360 as the minimum threshold to be able to staff and support a comprehensive and stable elementary program. Maximizing the number of sites at or above this minimum threshold allows the district to maximize the number of students who experience grade-level classrooms, comprehensive core enrichments, and targeted academic supports. It also maximizes the number of educators who work full-time on one campus and who benefit from regular collaboration with grade- and content-alike colleagues.

By operating fewer elementary schools and spreading current enrollment more evenly across remaining sites, the district can offer a more comprehensive and sustainable program at each elementary site.

In recent years, we have used resources from other parts of our system to subsidize elementary programs with low enrollment. With the revenue shortfall we have recently experienced and anticipate continuing to experience, our capacity to subsidize underenrollment has diminished and elementary schools have already experienced the following reductions and programmatic constraints:

- Over half of our elementary programs have been forced to place students in multi-grade classrooms;
- Staffing for instructional coaching, academic coaching, and school climate support positions have been reduced;
- Core enrichment teachers that support Arts, PE, and Library/Media instruction have been split across multiple sites, reducing the capacity to have full-school enrichment programs;
- Support staff that help monitor lunch and recess have been reduced, forcing principals to spend much of their time monitoring duty;

- Opportunities for strong teacher collaboration and professional learning have been compromised by multi-grade classrooms and single-strand programs.

If we continue with no rightsizing action, all of these constraints will be compounded in 2027-2028.

3b. Effects on Other Schools, Enrollment, and Community Access

The proposed merger would affect Atkinson and Glencoe within the Franklin cluster. Enrollment at Atkinson is projected to change from 366 to 474 in 2027. Enrollment at Glencoe is projected to change from 339 to 312 in 2027. Atkinson is ready to receive the new students, with minor upgrades in the kitchen, including a new warming cabinet and milk cooler. Glencoe will need an updated double oven and warming cabinet in the kitchen, as well as some accessibility upgrades, such as digital readerboard upgrades to support the incoming Deaf and Hard of Hearing program.

Creston is located approximately 1–1.5 miles from Atkinson, depending on the route. Nearby schools and community resources include Franklin High School, Clinton Park, and Champions childcare at Atkinson. The proposed change would shift students' daily school activities toward Atkinson and Clinton Park, while potentially increasing travel to existing childcare arrangements and resources near Creston. Transportation options include walking, biking, family transportation, school bus service for eligible students, and public transit along the Powell and Division corridors. Potential barriers include longer walking distances and crossings of SE Powell Boulevard and other busy streets. PPS would support school bus service for students who live more than one mile from the school and work with the school community and the district Safe Routes to School coordinator to identify appropriate crossing, pedestrian, and bicycle safety measures.

3c. Community Partnerships and Potential Community Impact

Creston currently partners with Grow Portland, which teaches a gardening class during the school day. This program is not funded through the Racial Equity & Social Justice (RESJ) department; schools contribute to program costs through a sliding fee scale based on their percentage of students eligible for free and reduced-price meals. Closure could affect student access to this programming. Opportunities for the partnership to continue include Atkinson, which already offers Grow Portland, and the program is expected to expand to serve Creston students projected to transition there. Services requiring further coordination include working with Grow Portland and Atkinson to plan for the program's expansion. Additional community impacts are expected to be limited for this partnership, with proposed responses including coordinating with Atkinson's building leaders and Grow Portland to support a smooth transition. Future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

Creston currently partners with Champions to provide child care for approximately 50 students. Relocating the program to Atkinson would allow families to maintain their existing provider relationship, as Champions already serves approximately 45 students at Atkinson. However, combining the programs would increase enrollment to approximately 95 students, requiring additional appropriately licensed space, staffing, and operational resources. We ask that

Champions and Atkinson administration be included in early transition planning to identify sufficient space, evaluate facility modifications and licensing requirements, and develop a sustainable plan that accommodates both school communities. Clear communication and adequate planning time will be essential to minimize disruptions for families and protect existing child care services. Preserving this partnership requires ensuring Champions has the space and support necessary to continue serving all 95 students without compromising the quality or availability of care.

Creston currently partners with Impact NW to operate its SUN Community School, providing wraparound services and family support through collaboration among PPS, Multnomah County and the City of Portland. Impact NW provides free extended-day enrichment opportunities, culturally relevant programming supported by staff who reflect and understand the student population, and access to basic-needs resources, including a food pantry. Additional SUN services specific to Creston include Big Group Games recess support, Creston Community Mutual Aid (CCMA), Urban Gleaners food distributions, winter gift shop programming, resource navigation and utility assistance, summer programming, and community-building events such as BIPOC Family Night, STEAM Night, and community yoga classes. SUN serves as an important connection point for students and families to access enrichment, individualized support, community resources, and basic-needs assistance. Closure could significantly disrupt student and family access to these established services, trusted relationships, and community partnerships, while also affecting Impact NW's ability to provide consistent, school-based support to the Creston community. Opportunities for partnerships to continue would require further coordination, as students would transition to Atkinson, which does not currently operate a SUN Community School. Unlike transitions to schools with an existing SUN program, there is no established SUN service infrastructure at Atkinson to absorb Creston's existing programming, staffing, partnerships, and family support services.

Services requiring alternatives or further coordination include identifying how students and families will continue accessing wraparound services, food distributions, resource navigation, enrichment opportunities, summer programming, and community-based supports currently provided through Impact NW and its partners. Additional community impacts include the potential loss of an established access point for families experiencing barriers to basic needs, increased challenges navigating community resources, disruption of trusted relationships with SUN staff, and reduced access to enrichment and engagement opportunities that support student well-being and academic success. Proposed responses include a coordinated district effort with Impact NW, Atkinson school leadership, and community partners to identify students and families currently accessing Creston SUN services, establish warm handoffs to alternative resources, assess opportunities to maintain existing partnerships and programming at other locations, and identify potential service gaps requiring additional support or funding. Particular consideration should be given to ensuring families do not lose access to essential basic-needs resources and that students maintain connections to meaningful enrichment and community supports following the transition.

Any future community use of the facility would be considered through the Building Repurposing process.

3d. Operational Plan & Boundary Map

If approved, the closure would take effect in 2027, with neighborhood students assigned to Atkinson under the proposed boundaries shown in the attached boundary map and CRIS DHH program moving to Glencoe.

Operational Implementation Plan

Timeline*	Action
January 2027	Establish school transition teams and school-specific implementation plans. Verify student enrollment. Share Principal assignments with communities.
February 2027	Develop staffing plans and confirm initial staff assignments. Identify and prioritize building improvements, equipment, and technology needs.
March 2027	Identify initial classroom assignments and develop school-specific moving schedules, distribute packing supplies, and begin records transfers.
April 2027	Begin packing and sorting materials not needed for daily instruction. Finalize plans for building improvements and technology setup.
May 2027	Confirm summer moving and building-work schedules. Continue packing and prepare materials for transportation and other operational services for receiving schools.
June 2027	Complete teacher packing. Begin school moves after the school year ends and carry out scheduled building improvements.
July 2027	Continue school moves and building improvements. Install furniture, equipment, and technology at receiving schools.
August 2027	Complete scheduled moves by mid August. Finish cleaning, classroom setup, and technology testing.
September 2027	Monitor school operations and address remaining transition needs. Complete closing-building inventories.

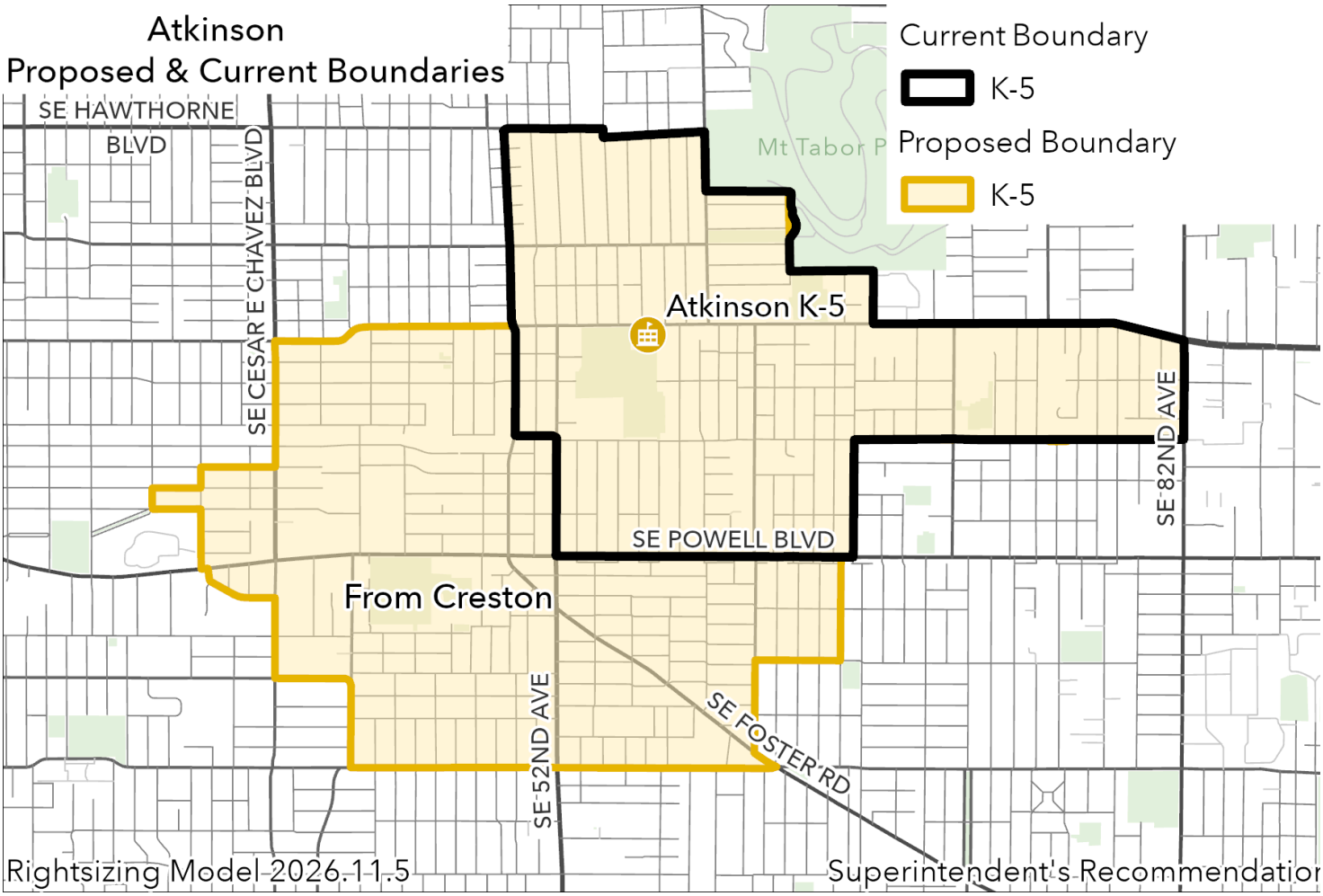
**Subject to change*

Review and Approval

This report has been reviewed by appropriate district staff.

Superintendent Signature

Date


Atkinson
Proposed & Current Boundaries
Current Boundary
K-5
Proposed Boundary
K-5
SE HAWTHORNE BLVD
SE CESAR E CHAVEZ BLVD
Mt Tabor P
Atkinson K-5
SE 82ND AVE
SE POWELL BLVD
From Creston
SE 52ND AVE
SE FOSTER RD
Rightsizing Model 2026.11.5
Superintendent's Recommendation